

Mapping With Melanin™ — Kinfolk Web Experience Fix

PRIORITY: P1 (Critical UX — must fix for testers)

The Problem

Kinfolk on the web is currently labeled "Plan your next trip." This is **WRONG**. Kinfolk is not a travel planner — it is a **culturally intelligent life companion**. The mobile app has the full Kinfolk experience (voice settings, life journey, vibe DNA, smart promotions, crisis protocols, lifestyle services, cross-city bridges) but the web version only received a basic chat widget with a travel-focused label.

The backend API already supports everything. The web frontend simply isn't calling the same endpoints or surfacing the same capabilities. This is a **frontend gap, not a backend gap**.

Fix 1: The Floating Bubble Text

Current: "KinfolkAI — Plan your next trip"

Correct: The bubble text should be **CONTEXTUAL** based on what page the user is on:

Page	Bubble Text
Homepage	"KinfolkAI — What can I help with?"
Map / Explore	"KinfolkAI — Need help finding something?"
Business detail page	"KinfolkAI — Want to know what the community says?"
Safety pages	"KinfolkAI — I'm here if you need me"
Community pages	"KinfolkAI — Let's connect you"
Profile	"KinfolkAI — How can I help today?"
Any other page	"KinfolkAI — Ask me anything"

Implementation: In `layout.tsx` line 239, replace the static "Plan your next trip" with a dynamic subtitle based on `window.location.pathname` or the current route.

Fix 2: The Navigation Label

Current: "KinfolkAI Travel Planner" in the nav menu

Correct: Just "KinfolkAI™" — no qualifier. It's not a travel planner. It's everything.

If a subtitle is needed for the nav: "KinfolkAI™ — Your Community Companion"

Fix 3: Initial Greeting (when chat opens)

Current: Travel-focused prompt or generic empty state

Correct — New User (first time opening Kinfolk):

"Hey! I'm Kinfolk — your community companion. I can help you find trusted businesses, keep you safe in unfamiliar places, connect you with your community, or just talk. What's on your mind?"

Correct — Returning User:

"Welcome back, [firstName]! What can I help with today?"

Correct — Returning User with context (if they have a life journey, saved businesses, etc.):

"Hey [firstName]! Last time we talked about [topic]. Want to pick up where we left off, or something new?"

Fix 4: Quick-Action Chips (suggested prompts below the greeting)

Current: Travel-focused suggestions only

Correct: Show 4-6 contextual chips that represent the FULL range of what Kinfolk can do:

Default chips (no user context yet):

- "Find a business near me"
- "Is this area welcoming?"
- "Help me plan something"

- "I need a recommendation"
- "Tell me about this city"

Chips for users with saved data:

- "What's new near me?"
- "Continue my [journey name]"
- "Find something like [last saved business]"
- "Safety check for [upcoming trip city]"

Chips on specific pages:

- On a business page: "What do people say about this place?" / "Is this worth the visit?" / "Find something similar"
- On the map: "What's the vibe here?" / "Show me hidden gems" / "Where should I eat?"
- On safety: "Is this area welcoming?" / "Report something" / "I don't feel safe"

Fix 5: Surface the Full Kinfolk Capabilities on Web

The mobile app calls these Kinfolk features that the web does NOT:

Feature	Mobile	Web	Fix
Voice settings (Professional → Home)	✓	✗	Add voice preference to web chat settings
Life Journey integration	✓	✗	Surface journey context in web chat
Vibe DNA (behavior-based recommendations)	✓	✗	Pass vibe data to web chat API calls
Smart promotions (proactive business suggestions)	✓	✗	Show inline business cards in web chat
Cross-city bridges	✓	✗	Surface when user mentions travel
Lifestyle services matching	✓	✗	Include in web recommendations

Crisis protocols	✓	?	Verify web chat handles crisis keywords
City cultural context	✓ (pending deploy)	✗	Include city context in web chat system prompt

The fix is straightforward: The web chat component needs to pass the same user context (preferences, vibe DNA, life journey, saved businesses) to the `/api/kinfolk/chat` endpoint that the mobile app passes. The backend already handles it — the web frontend just isn't sending the data.

Fix 6: Kinfolk Should NEVER Say These Things

Never say	Why	Say instead
"Plan your next trip"	Reduces Kinfolk to a travel tool	"What can I help with?"
"I'm a travel planner"	Same	"I'm your community companion"
"As a Black person, you might..."	One-Way Mirror Rule violation	"Since you've been browsing [category]..."
"Based on your race..."	One-Way Mirror Rule violation	"Based on what you've saved..."
"I don't know" (without offering help)	Feels like abandonment	"I'm not sure about that yet, but let me find out"
"Sorry, I can't help with that"	Feels like rejection	"That's outside what I can do right now, but here's what I can help with..."

Fix 7: The "Sewing Machine" Use Case

The founder described this scenario: A young woman whose sewing machine broke is stitching by hand. An older woman with disposable income might donate money to replace it. WHERE would the young woman even ask?

Kinfolk should be able to facilitate this. When someone says "I need help with..." or "My equipment broke" or "I can't afford...", Kinfolk should:

1. Acknowledge with empathy: "That's tough. Let me see how the community can help."
2. Suggest options: "You could post in the Community Marketplace, or I can connect you with community members who've offered to help with [category]."
3. Guide them to the right place: direct them to the marketplace, mutual aid section, or community feed.

This requires the web to HAVE a marketplace/mutual aid section — which is currently missing (flagged in the All Outstanding Issues document as P1 #15).

Verification

After implementing, confirm:

- ☐ Bubble text changes based on the page you're on
 - ☐ Nav says "KinfolkAI™" not "KinfolkAI Travel Planner"
 - ☐ Opening chat shows the correct greeting (new vs. returning user)
 - ☐ Quick-action chips are diverse (not just travel)
 - ☐ Kinfolk responds to non-travel questions helpfully (try: "Where can I get my hair done?" / "Is this neighborhood welcoming?" / "I need help with something")
 - ☐ Crisis keywords trigger the correct protocol on web (test: "I don't feel safe")
 - ☐ Voice setting is accessible from web chat settings
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WHY THIS MATTERS

Kinfolk is the SOUL of the app. It's what makes MWM different from Yelp or Google Maps. If users open the chat and see "Plan your next trip," they think it's a travel chatbot and close it. If they see "What can I help with?" and get chips like "Is this area welcoming?" and "Find a business near me" — they realize this is something that KNOWS them and their community. That's the moment they stay.